

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3215

Name

Justin Scioli

Emailjustinscioli@gmail.com**Gender**

Male

City, state, and country of residence

Lafayette, Louisiana, USA

Nationality

American

When did or will you finish your PhD?

May 2022

University Education

Ph.D. | Environmental and Evolutionary Biology | University of Louisiana at Lafayette | Spring 2022

M.S. | Biology | University of California, San Diego | Spring 2014

B.S. | Biology: Ecology, Behavior and Evolution | University of California, San Diego | Spring 2012

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

The mission of Science Corps strongly resonates with me. As an evolutionary biologist who works on largely tropical organisms, the discrepancy between the global centers of biodiversity and the centers of biodiversity research has long stood out to me as a problematic issue. The native peoples

of biodiversity hotspots (e.g. South and Central America, Africa, southeast Asia and the tropical Pacific) should be leading the world in biological research on the fauna and flora of hyperdiverse communities, however most of the research on these topics is conducted by researchers in developed nations. Given the context of the present biodiversity crisis, it is my opinion that training local researchers in the tropics is a necessary step to facilitate connections between the local peoples and ecosystems. The opportunity to work at CVIF in Jagna stood out to me as an excellent opportunity that combined my research interests in biodiversity and molecular sequencing of marine invertebrates as well as my ethical perspective on the need for fostering local biodiversity researchers through science education and training.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

As an undergraduate and graduate student, I had multiple opportunities to conduct fieldwork in tropical ecosystems, specifically in Sulawesi, Indonesia with Operation Wallacea; in Carrie Bow Cay, Belize, at the Smithsonian Institution marine field station with my doctoral advisor and labmates; and in Bocas del Toro, Panama, at the Smithsonian Tropical Research Institute, where I was a short term fellow. While an undergraduate research assistant with Operation Wallacea, I was able take part in training and instruction of local schoolchildren in identifying local animals, which I found an especially rewarding experience. Although I have not specifically used the MinION platform, I have generated an analyzed next generation sequencing data on the Illumina MiSeq platform.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

My personal professional goals are to continue to conduct research in biodiversity and evolution of marine invertebrates, specifically crustaceans. My ideal eventual position would be as a curator of a crustacean collection at a natural history museum. As museums are repositories of biological specimens and data, centers of biodiversity research, and gateways between science and the general public through exhibits, a career in a natural history museum would provide opportunities for all of my major interests and objectives. Because curator positions are rare and extremely competitive, in the short term I plan to build upon my research and make myself competitive for these positions through academic postdoctoral positions. If possible, I would like to build a long-term career in Asia, Australia, or the tropical Pacific as I have particular fondness of the marine faunas of these regions.

CV/Resume

 [CV2023.docx](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

EvoDir

Any other comments/questions?

Thank you for your consideration.

[Science Corps](#)